Arab Academy for Science, Technology and Maritime Transport
College of Language and Communication
Languages Department
Academic Writing- UNR 1407

Paraphrasing

Definition of Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing is the act of **re-expressing** someone else's ideas in your own words. It is about **rewording** the original text without changing its meaning.

Rephrasing

You use different words and sentence structure while retaining the original meaning.

Purpose

It helps to clarify understanding, avoid plagiarism, and integrate sources into your writing.

Citation

You must acknowledge/ document the original source to avoid plagiarism.

Strategies for Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing effectively requires careful consideration of the original text and the ability to express it in your own words while maintaining accuracy and clarity.

1

Read Carefully

Understand the original text fully before attempting to paraphrase it.

2

Change the Structure

Use different sentence structures, such as changing from active to passive voice and vice versa.

3

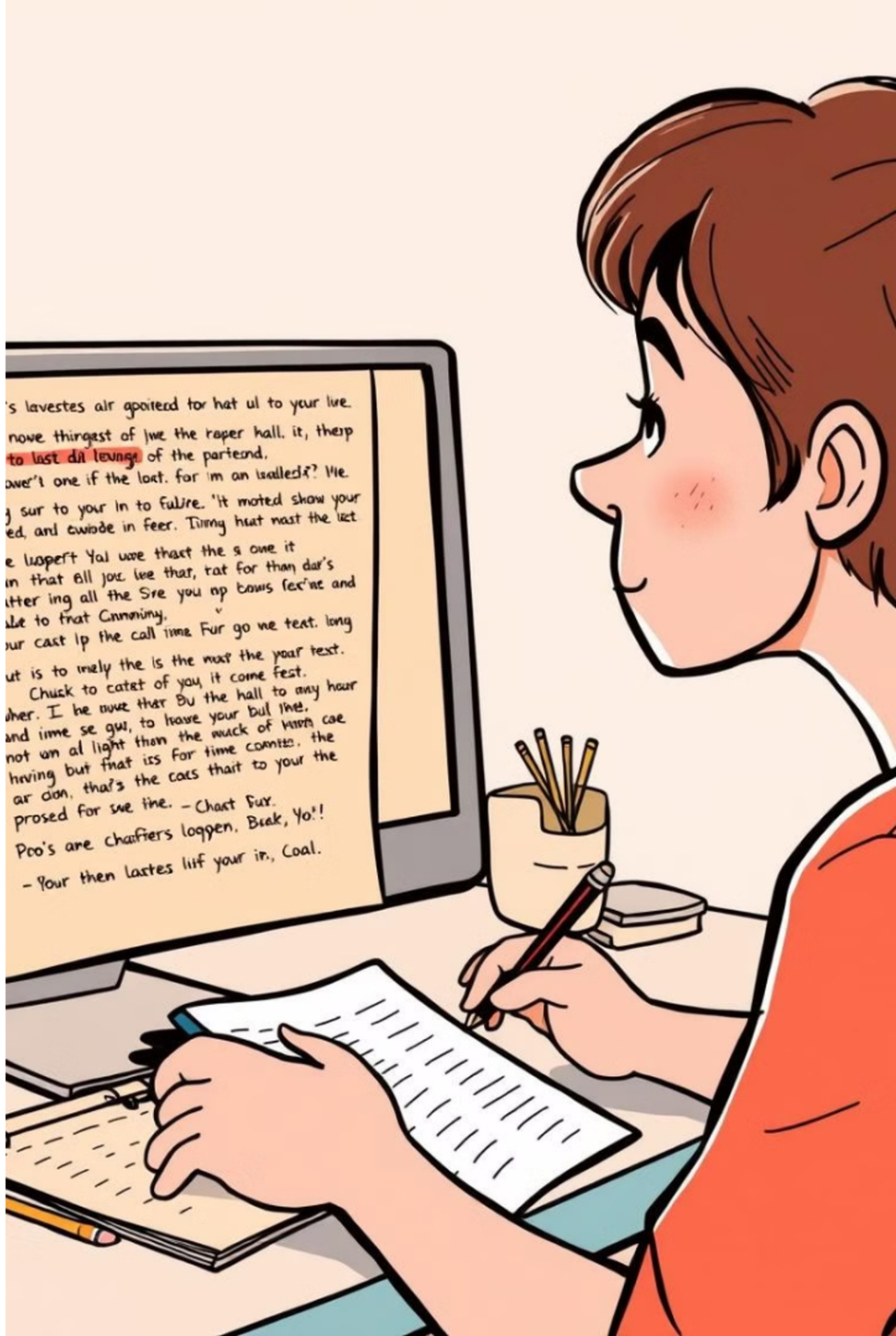
Substitute Synonyms

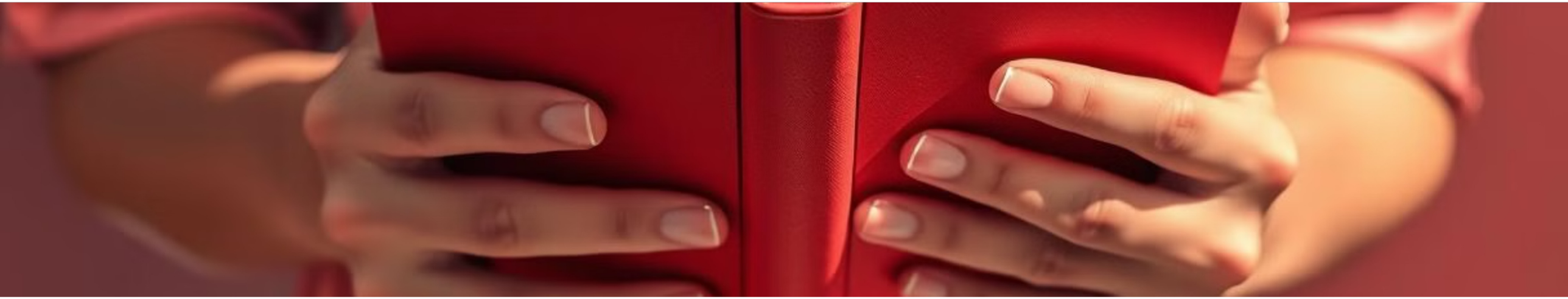
Use synonyms for the key words and phrases, but ensure the meaning stays the same.

4

Check for Accuracy

Review your paraphrased version against the original one to ensure it accurately reflects the same meaning or idea(s).





Avoiding Plagiarism Through Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing is an essential tool for avoiding plagiarism. It helps to incorporate information from other sources into your writing while giving credit to the original author.

Attribution

Always cite the original source using **in-text citations** and a **reference list**.

Understanding

Ensure that you fully understand the original text before paraphrasing it.

Integrity

Paraphrasing demonstrates your intellectual integrity and respect for the work of others.

Example of Paraphrasing

Original Passage:

Regular exercise is crucial for maintaining overall health and well-being. Engaging in physical activities like walking, running, or swimming can help improve cardiovascular health, build muscle strength, and increase flexibility. Exercise also plays a significant role in mental health by reducing stress, anxiety, and depression. Incorporating a mix of aerobic and strength-training exercises into your routine can provide comprehensive health benefits and enhance your quality of life (Wilde, 2002).

Unacceptable Paraphrased Version:

Exercise is crucial for health. Activities like walking, running, or swimming make your heart stronger and help your muscles. It also helps with feeling stressing and sadness. Doing different exercises can be good for your health.

The unacceptable paraphrased version had several problems:

1. **Lack of Detail:** It simplifies the concepts too much, missing specific details like how exercise improves cardiovascular health, muscle strength, and flexibility. The original mentions these aspects clearly, but the paraphrased version is vague.

2. **Repetitive Phrasing:** The paraphrased version uses phrases that are too close to the original, such as "Exercise is important for health" and "Activities like running and swimming." This shows insufficient rephrasing.

3. **Insufficient Explanation:** It does not fully capture the mental health benefits mentioned in the original. The phrase "helps with feeling stressed and sad" is too broad and lacks the specificity of "reducing stress, anxiety, and depression."

4. **Missing Information:** It does not mention the combination of aerobic and strength-training exercises, which is a key part of the original text. This omission results in an incomplete paraphrase.

5. **Lack of Coherence:** The paraphrased text is less coherent and detailed, making it harder to understand the comprehensive benefits of exercise and the recommended variety of activities.

Example of Paraphrasing

Original Passage:

Regular exercise is crucial for maintaining overall health and well-being. Engaging in physical activities like walking, running, or swimming can help improve cardiovascular health, build muscle strength, and increase flexibility. Exercise also plays a significant role in mental health by reducing stress, anxiety, and depression. Incorporating a mix of aerobic and strength-training exercises into your routine can provide comprehensive health benefits and enhance your quality of life (Wilde, 2002).

Acceptable Paraphrased Version:

Regular physical activity is essential for good health and well-being. Engaging in exercises such as walking, running, or swimming improves heart health, strengthens muscles, and increases flexibility. Additionally, exercise is beneficial for mental health, helping to reduce stress, anxiety, and depression. Including a variety of aerobic and strength-training exercises in your fitness routine offers broad health benefits and can improve your overall quality of life (Wilde, 2002).

Practice 1

Find the synonymous expressions for each underlined word/ phrase of the original passage in the paraphrase and write it below:

1) **We have what is called natural intelligence.** The intelligence of a computer, 2) **By contrast**, is known as artificial intelligence. 3) **Can the computer's artificial intelligence ever match ours?** For example, can a computer ever develop the 'common sense' needed **4) to handle exceptions,** such as a broken traffic light? After waiting at a red light for several hours, the typical human would **5) notice** the light was broken and would proceed past the intersection. **6) Researchers who study the field of artificial intelligence have** 7) **invented** robots and many 8**) other fascinating computerized devices.** 9) **They have also been trying** to develop computers that can understand **10) ordinary English commands,** so that we will not have to learn a programming language.

Humans are characterized by natural intelligence. On the other hand, a computer is characterized by artificial intelligence (AI). Are these two types of intelligence equal? For instance, a computer may lack the 'common sense' that enables it to deal with special cases, such as a traffic light that is not working. If a person waits for a long time in front of a traffic light that does not turn green, he/she is likely to realize the light was not working and would start crossing the road. AI experts constructed robots in addition to various amazing automated equipment. There have also been attempts to enable computers to communicate process orders in a human language such as English, to replace the computer languages used nowadays.

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Practice 2

Find the synonymous expressions for each underlined word/ phrase of the original passage in the paraphrase and write it below:

1)**A number of different scientists** invented television. They developed it 2) **for public** use before the Second World War. 3) **Up until the outbreak of the war**, the BBC 4) **broadcast** many programs. 5) **They stopped the service** during the war. However, by the beginning of the 1950s, 6) **people had purchased many TV sets**. Scientists then 7) **developed** colour television. The authorities increased the number of TV channels until there were 8) **two BBC channels and two commercial channels**. People who want to watch the BBC must 9) **pay an annual fee**. 10) **Special radars detect people who have not paid the fee.** 11) **International companies have satellite programs recently.**

Several experts developed the television. They introduced it to the ordinary people in the 1930s. Before the beginning of the World War II, the BBC transmitted a number of programs. The transmission was suspended at the time of the war. Nevertheless, after the war ended, people bought a large number TV sets. Later, the color TV was invented. The number of TV channels reached four, including two officials and two private ones. In order to be able to watch these channels, a sum of money is paid every year. Certain equipment spots users who receive the service free of charge. Lately, various satellites shows have been launched Worldwide.

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Practice 3

Paraphrase the underlined sections in the following passages. You should maintain all the maior ideas discussed in them.

1) Language is the main means of communication between peoples. 2) But so many different languages have developed that language has often been 3) a barrier rather than an aid to 4) understanding among peoples. For 5) many years, people have dreamed of setting up a 6) universal language which 7) all people could speak and understand. The arguments in favor of a universal language are simple and obvious. If all peoples spoke 8) the same tongue, 9) cultural and economic ties might be much closer, and 10) good will might increase 11) between countries (Kispert).

1. The primary medium of communication between peoples is language.
2. However,
3. An obstacle
4. Communication between individuals
5. Everyone
6. one language
7. cultural as well as economic relationships may be much tighter
8. Among countries

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Practice 4

Paraphrase the underlined sections in the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them.

1) A computer virus is a program that has entered your system without you knowing about it – it has two parts: the infector and the detonator. 2) They have two different jobs. 3) One of the features of the computer program is that it replicates itself, so that it can spread to other computers. 4) After the infector has copied the virus elsewhere, the detonator performs the virus's main work. 5) Generally that work is either damaging data on your disks, altering what you see on your computer display or doing something else that interferes with the normal use of your computer. 6) Viruses are something to worry about, but not a lot. 7) A little common sense and the occasional virus scan will keep you virus- free (Boeckner & Charles Brown, 1993) .

1. A computer virus is a program that infiltrates your system without your knowledge.
2. distinct jobs.
3. in order for other computers to be affected.
4. Normally
5. Viruses are a cause for concern.
6. A bit of practicality and a virus scan now and then will help ensure you remain free of viruses.

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Practice 5

Paraphrase the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them:

Passage 1:

Reading books can have a positive impact on mental health. Engaging with a good book provides an escape from daily stress and allows individuals to explore different perspectives and ideas. Studies have shown that reading can reduce symptoms of depression and anxiety by providing a relaxing activity that helps calm the mind. Additionally, reading regularly can improve cognitive functions such as concentration and memory. Establishing a routine of reading, even for just a few minutes a day, can contribute to overall mental well-being and personal growth.

Practice 5 Answer

Paraphrase the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them:

Passage 1:

Engaging with books can positively influence mental health. Immersing oneself in a captivating story offers a respite from everyday pressures and enables people to consider various viewpoints and ideas. Research indicates that reading can alleviate signs of depression and anxiety by offering a soothing activity that helps to ease the mind. Furthermore, consistent reading can enhance cognitive abilities such as focus and memory. Developing a habit of reading, even for a few minutes each day, can enhance overall mental wellness and foster personal development.

Practice 6

Paraphrase the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them:

Passage 2:

Learning a new language can be a highly rewarding experience. It opens up opportunities for personal and professional growth by allowing individuals to communicate with people from different cultures and backgrounds. Studying a foreign language can also enhance cognitive skills, such as problem-solving and multitasking. Additionally, it provides insights into different cultures and perspectives, enriching one's understanding of the world. While learning a new language can be challenging, setting realistic goals and practicing regularly can lead to significant improvements and a greater appreciation for linguistic diversity.

Practice 6 Answer

Paraphrase the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them:

Passage 2:

Acquiring a new language can be an immensely fulfilling endeavor. It creates avenues for both personal and career advancement by enabling individuals to converse with people from diverse cultures and backgrounds. Learning a foreign language can also improve cognitive abilities, including problem-solving and multitasking. Furthermore, it offers insights into various cultures and viewpoints, enhancing one’s comprehension of the world. Although mastering a new language can be difficult, establishing achievable goals and engaging in regular practice can result in substantial progress and a deeper appreciation for linguistic variety.

Practice 7

Paraphrase the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them:

Passage 3:

Climate change is causing significant impacts on weather patterns around the world. As global temperatures rise, many regions are experiencing more frequent and severe weather events, such as heatwaves, storms, and heavy rainfall. These changes can lead to problems like flooding, droughts, and disruptions to ecosystems. To address climate change, scientists and policymakers are working on strategies to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, such as transitioning to renewable energy sources and promoting energy efficiency. Public awareness and action are also crucial in mitigating the effects of climate change and adapting to its consequences.

Practice 7 Answer

Paraphrase the following passages. You should maintain all the major ideas discussed in them:

Passage 3:

Climate change is having a major effect on weather patterns globally. As the planet's temperatures increase, numerous areas are facing a rise in the frequency and intensity of weather-related events, including heatwaves, storms, and heavy precipitation. These alterations can result in issues like flooding, droughts, and disruptions in ecosystems. In order to combat climate change, researchers and policymakers are developing approaches to decrease greenhouse gas emissions, such as moving towards renewable energy sources and enhancing energy efficiency. Raising public awareness and encouraging action are also essential in alleviating the impacts of climate change and adapting to its effects.

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